

PATIENT HEALTH QUESTIONNAIRE-9

PHQ-9

Member Name: _____

Member ID: _____

Date of Assessment: _____

Assessor's Name: _____

It is important to note that coding the presence of clinical signs and symptoms of a depressed mood does not automatically mean that the member has a diagnosis of depression or other mood disorder.

Directions:

- Administer the PHQ-9 if the member's response to the Community Health Assessment Mood Question "In the last 3 days, how often have you felt 'sad, depressed, or hopeless?" is "1" (Not in last 3 days, but often feels that way), "2" (In 1-2 of last 3 days), or "3" (Daily in last 3 days).
- Start the assessment by saying, "I am going to ask you some questions about your mood and feelings over the last 2 weeks. I will also ask you about some common problems that are known to go along with feeling down. Some of the questions might seem personal, but everyone is asked to answer them. This will help us provide you with better care. Please tell me how often you have been bothered, over the last 2 weeks, by any of the following problems."
- Read each question verbatim, as written in the questionnaire, without any paraphrasing to maintain the integrity of the assessment. After each question, clearly state the four response options: "not at all," "several days," "more than half the days," and "nearly every day," ensure that members understand the response options without influencing their answers. Avoid offering opinions or suggestions during the interview process.
- For each question, record the member's response by using the drop-down menu corresponding to the appropriate frequency, scroll through the options, and select the numerical value. Ensure that unanswered questions remain set to the default "--". The total score will be calculated automatically. Document the member's PHQ-9 Score on the UAS under SECTION D Mood and Behavior - Comments.
- If a member is unable to or refuses to answer all 9 of the following questions, please follow these steps:
 - Assess the situation and determine the reason why the PHQ-9 assessment cannot be completed. This could be due to various factors such as cognitive limitations a communication impairment, or patient discomfort, or refusal.
 - Navigate to the drop-down menu provided at the bottom of this assessment tool below the question and response grid.
 - Carefully review the list of reasons available in the drop-down menu.
 - Select the option that best represents the reason the PHQ-9 could not be completed.
 - Document in the comment section on the UAS under SECTION D Mood and Behavior- that the PHQ-9 was not completed, include the reason why and any relevant observations or member feedback that might help understand the context or make future assessments more successful.

Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by any of the following problems?	Not At All (0)	Several Days (1)	More Than Half the Days (2)	Nearly Every Day (3)
Little interest or pleasure in doing things				
Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless				
Trouble falling or staying asleep, or sleeping too much				
Feeling tired or having little energy				
Poor appetite or overeating				
Feeling bad about yourself—or that you are a failure or have let yourself or your family down				
Trouble concentrating on things, such as reading the newspaper or watching television				
Moving or speaking so slowly that other people could have noticed. Or the opposite—being so fidgety or restless that you have been moving around a lot more than usual				
Thoughts that you would be better off dead, or of hurting yourself				
Column Total:				
PHQ-9 Score				

If PHQ-9 cannot be completed, select the most appropriate reason from the drop-down below:

PHQ-9 cannot be completed due to: _____

Assessor's Signature: _____

Date: _____